25901352 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCJMC202 - MEDIA AND COMMUNICATION ETHICS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. Duty-based-ethis is also called_____ [K] / [CO1]

   a). morality b). deontology

   c). natural values d). values

2. _____ preceeds morality and act as foundational beliefs that inform ethics and morals [An] / [CO1]

   a). morals b). ethics

   c). values d). nature

3. While reporting a traumatic event, the following should be avoided… [U] / [CO2]

   a). Identifying victims b). Identifying minors

   c). Identifying victims without consent d). All of these

4. _____originaly meant a scientific way of reporting [U] / [CO2]

a). Accuracy b). objectivity

c). fairness d). None of these

5. Private Treaties' in media refer to: [K] / [CO2, CO4]

a). Legal agreements between journalists and their sources

b). Government-media agreements on national security reporting

c). Deal between media and corporates where the media house gets equity shares in exchange for positive news coverage

d). Agreements between rival newspapers not to poach journalists

6. Journalists must do the following to minimise fake news and online bullying [U] / [CO2]

a). Avoid amplifying false claims b). Clearly label misinformation

c). Ethically counter troll campaigning d). All of these

7. How does 'selective editing' in broadcast journalism constitute an ethical violation? [U] / [CO3]

a). By reducing the length of news programmes

b). By improving the pacing of broadcast news

c). By focusing on the most important parts of an interview

d). By creating a misleading impression for audiences

8. A digital barrier on websites that restricts access to content, requiring a payment, subscription, or login to unlock it is: [K] / [CO3]

a). Open content b). Paywindow

c). Paywall d). Paylater

9. The concept which says that advertisers must have evidence for claims before they are made is: [U] / [CO5]

a). Substantiation

b). Endorsement

c). Sustainability

d). Confidentiality

10. Advertising ethics is concerned primarily with ensuring that advertisements are: [K] / [CO5]

a). Truthful, non-deceptive, fair, and socially responsible

b). Visually attractive and memorable

c). As persuasive as possible regardless of truth

d). Only regulated by market competition

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer Type Questions (100 words)

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **3** marks

11. Explain the central features of the concept of external accountability. [U] / [CO1]

12. Write a short note on PCI's ethical guidelines for journalists. [U] / [CO1]

13. Describe the importance of media ethics in a democratic society. [U] / [CO1]

14. Explain the role of ASCI in setting the professional standards advertising industry. [U] / [CO1]

15. Explain the two elements upon which professional ethics of journalism is founded. [U] / [CO2]

16. Suggest atleast three measures to prevent unethical practices such as bribery and junkets in media organizations. [K] / [CO2, CO4]

17. Explain the need of source confidentiality in reporting. [U] / [CO2, CO4]

18. What is objectivity of journalistic method ? [U] / [CO2]

19. Define plagiarism in journalism. [K] / [CO3]

20. Define conflict of interest in the context of advertising and editorial content [U] / [CO3]

21. State any three principles from the PRSI's Code of Ethics for Public Relations in India [K] / [CO5]

22. Define the term spin in public relations [K] / [CO5]

[3x10 = 30]

Part C

Essay Type Questions (450 Words)

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

23. Explain the role of media as the fourth estate. [U] / [CO1]

24. List the types of primary and secondary sources and the ways in which they impact the weight of a story. [U] / [CO2]

25. Describe the ethical responsibilities involved in data visualization. Why is accuracy and clarity important when presenting visual data. [U] / [CO3]

26. Describe the importance of verification in online journalism, especially during breaking news situations. [U] / [CO3]

[15x2 = 30]